

A FRAMEWORK IN CHAPTERS

Chapter Seventeen

Ethnic Majoritarianism

*The system that ranks the ethnic majority
above ethnic minorities in the state*

Ethnic Majoritarianism is the system that ranks the ethnic majority above ethnic minorities in a given state, enforces ethnic identity as political category, and extracts political power, resources, and cultural recognition from minorities. This chapter runs it through the five domains — from the state-of-origin form to the Biafra War to the slow death of minority languages in a majoritarian state.

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CHAPTER 17 OF AN ONGOING FRAMEWORK

Ethnic Majoritarianism

Ethnic Majoritarianism is the sixteenth Fundamental Matrix. It is the system that ranks the ethnic majority above ethnic minorities in a given state, enforces ethnic identity as political category, and extracts political power, resources, and cultural recognition from minorities. The framework's outline names it alongside Territorialism (Chapter 18) as the two matrices that combine to form the Nationalism intersection.

Ethnic Majoritarianism overlaps with Coloniality (Chapter 11, which produced the ethnic classification system through colonial codification) and with Rankism (Chapter 2, which ranks by position). But the three matrices are not the same. Coloniality ranks by colonial origin. Rankism ranks by position. Ethnic Majoritarianism ranks by ethnic identity — the assumption that the ethnic majority has the right to dominate the state. The framework separates them so that each logic can be studied and dismantled.

A note on method. The Interpersonal, Disciplinary, and Structural sections take the naive approach — each triad described as if happening for the first time, with no networks, residues, or Canon referenced. The Hegemonic Domain section is where Canon and Practice finally enter the picture.

READING NOTE

Same convention as Chapters 1 through 16. Every paragraph is written to be tweetable. Where you see literal blanks (____), the framework is asking you to write yourself into it. This chapter's blanks may be uncomfortable: every Nigerian has filled in 'state of origin' on a form, has heard an ethnic joke, or has been classified by ethnic group before being addressed by name. The framework asks you to see that classification as enforcement, not as neutral administration.

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SECTION 1

1. Definition: What Ethnic Majoritarianism Extracts, Enforces, and Removes

Ethnic Majoritarianism is the system that ranks the ethnic majority above ethnic minorities in a given state. The theoretical foundations draw on Mahmood Mamdani's *Define and Rule* (2012), which showed how the colonial state constructed ethnic identity as a political category for administrative convenience, and how this construction persisted after independence. Mamdani's *Citizen and Subject* (1996) showed how the colonial bifurcation of citizen and subject was organised along ethnic lines.

Crawford Young's *The Politics of Cultural Pluralism* (1976) supplied the comparative framework for ethnic politics in postcolonial Africa. Donald Horowitz's *Ethnic Groups in Conflict* (1985) supplied the comprehensive analysis of ethnic conflict. Benedict Anderson's *Imagined Communities* (1983) showed how ethnic communities, like nations, are constructed through shared media, shared education, and shared administrative categories — not discovered as pre-existing facts.

For the Nigerian context, Richard Joseph's *Democracy and Prebendal Politics in Nigeria* (1987) showed how ethnic identity functions as a channel for resource distribution. Eghosa Osaghae's *Crippled Giant* (1998) documented the ethnic arithmetic that organises Nigerian political life. Rotimi Suberu's work on federalism and ethnic conflict showed how the federal structure both manages and reproduces ethnic tension. Abdul Raufu Mustapha's work on ethnic politics documented the specific Nigerian configurations.

Nigeria's ethnic landscape is complex. The three largest groups — Hausa-Fulani, Yoruba, and Igbo — together constitute roughly 60-70% of the population, with over 250 smaller ethnic groups constituting the remainder. The majoritarian logic does not simply rank one group above all others; it ranks the three large groups above the 250+ smaller groups, and within the three, it ranks whichever is politically dominant at a given moment. The result is a system in which ethnic identity determines political access, resource distribution, and social standing.

1.1 What Ethnic Majoritarianism Extracts

Ethnic Majoritarianism extracts six things. First, **minority political power**: the channelling of political authority to the majority, with the minority reduced to token representation. The federal character principle (Section 14(3) of the 1999 Constitution) requires ethnic balance in appointments but not in outcomes, so the minority gets the appointment without the power.

Second, **minority resources**: the channelling of state resources to majority areas, with minority areas receiving less infrastructure, less investment, and less attention. Third, **minority cultural recognition**: the treatment of minority languages, religions, and cultural practices as less important than majority ones. Fourth, **minority land**: the seizure of minority land for majority projects, from

dams to plantations to military installations.

Fifth, **minority labour at subsistence**: the exploitation of minority labour in majority-owned enterprises, with the minority worker paid less and promoted less. Sixth, **minority self-determination**: the removal of the minority's right to govern themselves, to control their resources, and to determine their own development priorities.

1.2 What Ethnic Majoritarianism Enforces

Ethnic Majoritarianism enforces four standards. First, **ethnic identity as political category**: the assumption that every Nigerian has an ethnic identity that determines their political access, their resource allocation, and their social standing. The 'state of origin' field on every form enforces this categorisation.

Second, the **majority's right to rule**: the assumption that the ethnic majority has the right to the presidency, the military leadership, and the economic commanding heights. The rotational presidency convention rotates among the three majority groups, not among all Nigerians. Third, the **minority's duty to accept**: the assumption that the minority must accept majority rule, must accept token representation, and must accept the ethnic quota as sufficient.

Fourth, the **indigene/settler distinction**: the assumption that the person whose ethnic group is native to a state has more rights than the person who has migrated to that state, regardless of how long the migrant has lived there. The distinction is codified in the 'indigene certificate' system, which determines access to education, employment, and political office.

1.3 What Options Ethnic Majoritarianism Removes

Concretely, Ethnic Majoritarianism removes the option of being non-ethnic. The Nigerian who would rather not be classified by ethnic group has no option, because every form requires 'state of origin,' every political party requires ethnic arithmetic, and every social encounter begins with the question 'where are you from?' which means 'what is your ethnic group?'

It removes the option of equal citizenship regardless of ethnic origin. The Nigerian who lives in a state that is not their 'state of origin' is a 'non-indigene' who pays higher university fees, cannot hold certain political offices, and may be denied employment in the state civil service. It removes the option of minority self-determination — the minority's right to govern themselves, to control their resources, and to determine their own development priorities.

It removes the option of indigenous land for minorities — the minority community whose land is seized for a federal project receives compensation (if any) that is determined by the majority-controlled state. It removes the option of political representation proportional to population — the federal character principle requires balance in appointments but not in outcomes, so the minority gets the token appointment without the structural power. It removes the option of cultural recognition equal to the majority — the minority language is not used in education, the minority religion is not recognised in public holidays, the minority cultural practice is not represented in

national media. Each removal is enforced by the constitution, by the state, and by the triads below.

SECTION 2 · NAIVE APPROACH

2. The Interpersonal Domain

The Interpersonal Domain contains four enforcement triads and four extraction triads. Each is described here as if happening for the first time — no networks, no residues, no Canon.

3.1 Enforcement Triad: Ethnic Identity as Political Category Standard

The enforcer is the person or institution that demands the subject be classified by ethnic group. The government form that requires ‘state of origin.’ The employer who asks ‘where are you from?’ The politician who mobilises by ethnic group. The security officer who profiles by ethnic appearance. The enforcement is performed by the form, by the question, by the mobilisation, or by the profiling.

The subject conforms by classifying themselves. The conforming act is the classification itself — the subject fills in the form, answers the question, joins the ethnic bloc, accepts the profiling. The subject who refuses classification is treated as suspicious or evasive.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The Nigerian who is classified by ethnic group loses the option to be non-ethnic, which is to say, loses the option to a national identity that is not mediated by ethnic origin. The Nigerian who is profiled by ethnic appearance loses the option to freedom from suspicion, which is to say, loses the option to bodily autonomy at the checkpoint.

The witness is the person who watches the classification and says nothing, or who themselves classify by ethnic group. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the institution that benefits from the ethnic classification — the employer who uses the classification to manage the workforce — without personally commanding the classification.

3.2 Enforcement Triad: Majority Right to Rule Standard

The enforcer is the person or institution that demands the ethnic majority’s right to political dominance. The political party that zones the presidency to a majority group. The elder who says ‘it is our turn.’ The media that frames the election as a contest between majority groups. The military that is dominated by one majority group. The enforcement is performed by the zoning convention, by the rhetoric, by the media framing, or by the military composition.

The subject conforms by accepting the majority’s right to rule. The conforming act is the acceptance itself — the subject votes for the majority candidate, accepts the zoning, does not challenge the military composition. The minority subject who challenges is treated as disruptive.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The minority Nigerian who is excluded from the presidency loses the option to the highest office, which is to say, loses the option to full political participation. The minority Nigerian who is excluded from the military leadership loses the option to security representation. The minority Nigerian who is excluded from the economic commanding

heights loses the option to economic power.

The witness is the person who watches the majority-rule enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves benefit from the majority's dominance. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the majority-group member who benefits from the dominance without personally commanding it.

3.3 Enforcement Triad: Indigene/Settler Distinction Standard

The enforcer is the person or institution that demands the indigene be treated as having more rights than the settler. The state university that charges the non-indigene higher fees. The state government that requires the indigene certificate for employment. The local government that denies the settler political office. The community that tells the settler to 'go back to your state.' The enforcement is performed by the fee structure, by the certificate requirement, by the political exclusion, or by the expulsion threat.

The subject conforms by accepting the distinction. The conforming act is the acceptance itself — the settler pays the higher fee, obtains the indigene certificate if possible, does not run for office, and does not challenge the expulsion threat. The settler who challenges is treated as ungrateful.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The non-indigene student who pays higher fees loses the option to equal education, which is to say, loses the option to economic mobility. The non-indigene worker who cannot obtain state employment loses the option to economic security. The non-indigene resident who cannot run for office loses the option to political participation. The non-indigene who is told to 'go back' loses the option to security.

The witness is the person who watches the indigene/settler enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves benefit from indigene status. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the indigene who benefits from the distinction without personally commanding it.

3.4 Enforcement Triad: Ethnic Quota as Token Standard

The enforcer is the institution that implements the ethnic quota as sufficient. The government agency that appoints the token minority and declares the quota met. The university that admits the token minority and declares the quota met. The military that recruits the token minority and declares the quota met. The enforcement is performed by the appointment, by the admission, by the recruitment, or by the declaration.

The subject conforms by accepting the token. The conforming act is the acceptance itself — the minority accepts the appointment as sufficient, the minority accepts the admission as sufficient, the minority accepts the recruitment as sufficient. The minority who demands more than the token is treated as ungrateful.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The minority who accepts the token loses the option to structural power, which is to say, loses the option to outcomes rather than appointments. The minority who is appointed as token loses the option to credibility, because the appointment is treated as quota

rather than merit. The minority who demands proportional representation loses the option to social acceptance, because the demand is treated as divisive.

The witness is the person who watches the token enforcement and says nothing, or who themselves implement the quota. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the majority institution that benefits from the appearance of diversity without personally commanding the tokenism.

3.5 Extraction Triad: Minority Political Power

The extractor is the majority-controlled state that channels political power to the majority. The zoning convention that excludes minorities from the presidency. The party structure that channels minority votes to majority candidates. The military composition that concentrates command in majority hands. The extraction is performed by the zoning, by the party structure, by the military composition, or by the electoral system.

The subject conforms by surrendering political power. What is extracted is the political power itself — the right to govern, to decide, to allocate. The extraction transfers the power from the minority to the majority, with the minority reduced to token representation.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The minority that surrenders political power loses the option to self-governance, which is to say, loses the option to determining their own development priorities. The minority that is excluded from the presidency loses the option to the highest office. The minority that is excluded from military leadership loses the option to security representation.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the majority-group member who benefits from the concentrated political power without personally commanding the extraction.

3.6 Extraction Triad: Minority Resources

The extractor is the majority-controlled state that channels resources to majority areas. The federal allocation that directs infrastructure to majority constituencies. The state government that directs investment to majority local governments. The federal project that seizes minority land for majority benefit. The extraction is performed by the allocation, by the investment, by the project, or by the seizure.

The subject conforms by accepting the extraction. What is extracted is the resource itself — the land, the minerals, the water, the infrastructure budget. The extraction transfers the resource from the minority to the majority, with the minority receiving less or nothing.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The minority community whose land is seized loses the option to livelihood, which is to say, loses the option to subsistence. The minority constituency that receives less infrastructure loses the option to development. The minority local government that receives less investment loses the option to economic growth.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the majority constituency that receives the redirected resources without personally commanding the extraction.

3.7 Extraction Triad: Minority Cultural Recognition

The extractor is the majority-dominated culture that treats minority languages, religions, and cultural practices as less important. The education system that uses majority languages. The public holiday calendar that recognises majority religious festivals. The media that represents majority culture as national culture. The extraction is performed by the curriculum, by the calendar, by the media, or by the social treatment.

The subject conforms by accepting the majority culture. What is extracted is the cultural recognition itself — the visibility, the legitimacy, the resources for cultural production. The extraction transfers the recognition from the minority to the majority, with the minority culture eroded or erased.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The minority language that is not used in education loses the option to intergenerational transmission, which is to say, loses the option to survival. The minority religion that is not recognised in public holidays loses the option to public legitimacy. The minority cultural practice that is not represented in media loses the option to visibility.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the majority culture that benefits from the dominance without personally commanding the extraction.

3.8 Extraction Triad: Minority Self-Determination

The extractor is the majority-controlled state that removes the minority's right to self-governance. The federal structure that prevents minority states from controlling their resources. The federal character principle that prevents minority states from setting their own priorities. The military that prevents minority self-defence. The extraction is performed by the federal structure, by the federal character principle, by the military presence, or by the political exclusion.

The subject conforms by accepting the removal. What is extracted is the self-determination itself — the right to govern, to control resources, to set priorities, to defend. The extraction transfers the self-determination from the minority to the majority-controlled state.

The options the subject loses are concrete. The minority that loses self-determination loses the option to sovereignty, which is to say, loses the option to political existence. The minority that cannot control its resources loses the option to economic development. The minority that cannot set its own priorities loses the option to cultural survival.

The witness is the person who knows of the extraction and does not intervene. The Non-Extracting Beneficiary is the majority state that benefits from the minority's loss of self-determination without personally commanding the extraction.

Nascent forms of this system include: ‘State of origin’ as political category, ‘Indigene’ vs ‘settler’, ‘Sons of the soil’, ‘This is our land’, ‘Go back to your state’, ‘Federal character’ as token, ‘Zoning’ as ethnic arithmetic, ‘Our son/our daughter’ in politics, Ethnic voting bloc, ‘Are you Hausa/Yoruba/Igbo?’, Ethnic stereotyping in media, Ethnic jokes as enforcement, Ethnic slurs, The ethnic quota in employment, The ethnic quota in university admission, The ethnic quota in the military, The residency requirement for political office, Ethnic profiling at checkpoints, The ethnic militia, The ethnic cleansing in conflict zones, The ethnic census controversy, The rotating presidency as ethnic arithmetic.

SECTION 3 · NAIVE APPROACH

3. The Disciplinary Domain

When the eight triads above link into networks, Ethnic Majoritarianism scales. Both hierarchical and community-based forms are visible in every Nigerian institution that organises ethnic identity.

4.1 Disciplinary Hierarchy — Nested Stars

Peak Triad-Node

At the peak is the triad where the highest ethnic-majority authority enforces on the layer below. In the federal hierarchy, the peak is the President from a majority ethnic group, enforcing on the VP, who enforces on the Secretary to the Government, who enforces on the civil servant from a minority group. In the state hierarchy, the peak is the Governor from the ‘indigene’ group, enforcing on the Secretary, who enforces on the Local Government Chairman, who enforces on the ‘non-indigene’ resident.

In the traditional ruler hierarchy, the peak is the first-class chief from the majority group, enforcing on the second-class chief, who enforces on the third-class chief, who enforces on the minority village head. In the university hierarchy, the peak is the VC from the ‘host’ ethnic group, enforcing on professors, who enforce on lecturers, who enforce on the ‘non-indigene’ student paying higher fees.

Middle Triad-Nodes

The middle nodes are where the chain’s character is clearest. The Permanent Secretary from a majority group who defers to the President in the morning demands deference from the Director from a minority group in the afternoon. The indigene Local Government Chairman who defers to the Governor in the morning demands deference from the non-indigene resident in the afternoon. The middle is where Ethnic Majoritarianism reproduces — the majority-group member who is enforced on by the peak enforces on the minority below.

Bottom Triad-Node

At the bottom is the minority Nigerian — the person from a small ethnic group, the non-indigene resident, the settler in a state that is not their ‘state of origin.’ The minority Nigerian is the one who pays the higher fees, who cannot run for office, who is profiled at the checkpoint, who sees their language eroded, who watches their land seized. The bottom is where the system’s extraction is most concentrated.

4.2 Disciplinary Community — Distributed Network

A Disciplinary Community is a distributed network. The witness of one Ethnic Majoritarianism triad becomes the enforcer of another. The system spreads laterally through any person who has witnessed ethnic enforcement without dissenting.

The Ethnic Associations

The ethnic associations circulate Ethnic Majoritarianism laterally across the Nigerian political landscape. Afenifere (Yoruba), Ohanaeze Ndigbo (Igbo), the Arewa Consultative Forum (Hausa-Fulani North), the Middle Belt Forum, the South-South Peoples Assembly. Each association mobilises its ethnic group for political claims, reproducing the ethnic-identity-as-political-category triad across the political landscape.

The Ethnic Hometown Associations

The ethnic hometown associations circulate Ethnic Majoritarianism laterally across the Nigerian diaspora and urban population. The association that raises funds for the hometown, that organises the annual festival, that mobilises the community for the ethnic candidate. The associations reproduce the ethnic-voting-bloc triad across the urban and diaspora population.

The Ethnic Media

The ethnic media circulate Ethnic Majoritarianism laterally across the Nigerian media ecosystem. The newspaper that covers the ethnic group. The radio station that broadcasts in the ethnic language. The social media account that mobilises the ethnic group. The media reproduce the ethnic-identity-as-political-category triad across the media landscape.

The Ethnic Vigilante Groups

The ethnic vigilante groups circulate Ethnic Majoritarianism laterally through armed enforcement. The OPC (Yoruba), MASSOB (Igbo), Bakassi Boys (Igbo), Hisbah (Hausa). Each enforces ethnic claims through violence, reproducing the majority-right-to-rule triad through armed community enforcement.

The Ethnic Social Media Networks

The ethnic social media networks circulate Ethnic Majoritarianism laterally across the Nigerian digital public. The WhatsApp group that shares the ethnic joke. The Twitter account that mobilises the ethnic group. The Facebook page that propagates the ethnic stereotype. The networks reproduce the ethnic-identity-as-political-category triad across the digital public.

SECTION 4 · NAIVE APPROACH

4. The Structural Domain

Run the Ship of Theseus test. When the original colonial administrators who created the ethnic classification are dead and replaced, when the ethnic associations are disbanded and reform, what is consistent? What outlives both individuals and groups?

Ethnic Majoritarianism leaves all three residues. Almost every Nigerian institution carries Bureaucracy, Stratification, and Classification from Ethnic Majoritarianism simultaneously.

5.1 Bureaucracy — Enduring Rules and Procedures

Ethnic Majoritarianism's bureaucracy is the codified ethnic-classification structure. The 1999 Constitution's **federal character principle** (Section 14(3)) requires that appointments reflect the federal character of Nigeria, but the principle addresses appointments, not outcomes. The **Federal Character Commission** enforces the principle but has no power over outcomes.

The **'state of origin' and 'indigene' certificates** are bureaucratic instruments that classify every Nigerian by ethnic origin. The NYSC was established in 1973 as an ethnic mixing programme, but it has not dismantled the ethnic classification system. The **ethnic quota in federal employment** requires balance in hiring but not in promotion. The **ethnic quota in university admission** (the catchment area, the educationally less developed states) addresses access but not quality.

The **rotational presidency** is an informal convention that rotates the presidency among the majority groups, not among all Nigerians. The **ethnic census controversy** — the last census that counted by ethnic group was 1963; ethnic questions were removed from subsequent censuses because the count was too politically volatile. The **traditional ruler recognition laws** and the **chieftaincy laws** codify the hierarchy of chiefs, with first-class chiefs from majority groups ranking above minority village heads. The original colonial authors are dead. The bureaucracy lives.

5.2 Stratification — Enduring Zero-Sum Rankings

Ethnic Majoritarianism's stratification is the daily experience of ethnic rank in every institutional encounter. **Indigene/settler** — the indigene ranks above the settler in university fees, in employment, in political office, in social recognition. **Majority/minority** — the majority ethnic group ranks above the minority in political power, in resource allocation, in cultural recognition.

Host/guest — the host community ranks above the guest in territorial claims. **Native/stranger** — the native ranks above the stranger in belonging. **Sons of the soil/immigrants** — the son of the soil ranks above the immigrant in political rights. **First-class/third-class chief** — the majority chief ranks above the minority chief in the traditional ruler hierarchy. The ranking is in the air; it does not need to be announced.

5.3 Classification — Enduring Categorical Divisions

Ethnic Majoritarianism's classification is the set of categorical names that organise every Nigerian into ethnic categories. **Indigene** and **settler** — the universal pair, with indigene as the legitimate and settler as the temporary. **Majority** and **minority** — the political pair, with majority as the ruler and minority as the represented.

Host and **guest** — the territorial pair. **Native** and **stranger** — the belonging pair.

Hausa-Fulani/Yoruba/Igbo/minority — the ethnic hierarchy, with the three majority groups above the 250+ minority groups. **North/South** — the regional pair, with the North as the Muslim-majority region and the South as the Christian-majority region. **Christian North/Muslim North** — the sub-regional pair, with the Muslim North as the dominant and the Christian North (the Middle Belt) as the minoritised.

Indigene/non-indigene — the administrative pair, with indigene as the rights-holder and non-indigene as the rights-denied. The classification does the work before any individual enforcer shows up. A Nigerian walking into a state university admissions office is already classified; the officer does not need to ask 'are you an indigene?' because the form already requires the certificate.

SECTION 5

5. The Hegemonic Domain: The Ascension Ritual

Is Ethnic Majoritarianism ascended? Yes on all three counts. It produces all three structural residues including Stratification (so Internalised Domination applies). It has working Canon and Practice mechanisms. The vast majority of Nigerians cannot imagine a society without ethnic classification, without the state-of-origin form, without the indigene/settler distinction — despite the fact that ethnic identity as political category is a colonial construction.

6.1 Canon — Rewriting History

Canon is the present belief that ethnic identity as political category has always been so. The origination of the structural residues — the state-of-origin form, the federal character principle, the indigene certificate — has been forgotten. The average Nigerian now takes ethnic classification as natural, eternal, and without alternative.

What is forgotten? Ethnic identity as political category is a colonial construction. The British colonial state classified Nigerians by ethnic group for administrative convenience, through the census, the Native Authority system, and the indirect rule structure. Mamdani's *Define and Rule* (2012) showed how the colonial state defined ethnic groups as discrete, bounded, and politically relevant categories — erasing the more fluid ethnic boundaries of the pre-colonial period.

Also forgotten: that pre-colonial Nigerian ethnic boundaries were more fluid. The Yoruba who traded with the Hausa, the Igbo who intermarried with the Ijaw, the Fulani who settled among the Hausa — each crossing was unremarkable before the colonial state fixed the boundaries. The 1914 amalgamation combined ethnic groups that had not been previously unified under a single state, creating the political unit within which ethnic majoritarianism would operate.

Also forgotten: that the 'state of origin' is a colonial administrative residue. The colonial state required each subject to be administered through their Native Authority, which was tied to their ethnic territory. The post-colonial state retained the requirement as 'state of origin,' transforming the colonial administrative category into a post-colonial political category. The ethnic census was abandoned after the 1963 controversy, but the classification system that the census produced persists in every other form.

Internalised Domination

Canon produces Internalised Domination because Ethnic Majoritarianism produces Stratification. The majority ethnic group's entitlement to rule is now natural, automatic, unquestionable. The majority-group politician who expects the presidency as 'our turn' does not experience this as a demand. They experience it as the natural order. The indigene's entitlement to the state's resources is

natural. The host community's entitlement to priority is natural. The majority's entitlement to define national culture is natural.

Internalised Authority

Canon produces Internalised Authority in the Ethnic Majoritarianism enforcer regardless of personal material gain. The right to demand 'state of origin.' The right to treat the settler as guest. The right to implement the ethnic quota. The right to ethnic profiling. The right to mobilise the ethnic bloc. Each is performed by ordinary Nigerians daily — the employer who asks 'where are you from?' the university officer who demands the indigene certificate, the politician who mobilises by ethnic group, the security officer who profiles by ethnic appearance. The right to enforce feels natural, automatic, and legitimate.

Internalised Oppression

Canon produces Internalised Oppression in the minority subject and the non-indigene. The minority who believes they cannot rule. The non-indigene who believes they must accept. The settler who believes they are guest. The minority who believes their culture is inferior. The teaching is silent; it is in the air.

The deepest form of this is the subject who has absorbed Ethnic Majoritarianism so thoroughly that they enforce it on themselves. The minority Nigerian who says 'it is not our turn' to explain why they do not run for president. The non-indigene who says 'I am a guest here' to explain why they accept the higher fees. The minority who says 'my language is not important enough for education' to explain why they do not teach their children. The rebellion-capable subject has become the self-policing subject.

6.2 Practice — Rewriting Reality

Practice is the second mechanism of the Ascension Ritual. The interpersonal triad is repeated, again and again, until it becomes habit. Pierre Bourdieu called this *habitus* — the sediment of repeated practice in the body. The Nigerian child who learns their 'state of origin' before they learn their national identity is undergoing Practice for Ethnic Majoritarianism. The body learns. The mind stops questioning.

By adulthood, the Nigerian has filled in 'state of origin' on so many forms, heard so many ethnic jokes, navigated the indigene/settler distinction so many times, that the alternative — a society where ethnic identity is not a political category — feels like a kind of amputation. The body has been trained. Practice has rewritten reality.

Death — Fast and Slow

Practice produces Death. Fast death in Ethnic Majoritarianism is spectacular: the Kano riot of 1953. The Tiv riots of 1960-64. The Nigeria-Biafra War of 1967-70, with 1-3 million killed, the paradigm of ethnic majoritarianism's violence. The post-election violence of 2011, with over 800 killed. The Plateau conflicts of 2001-2010s, with thousands killed. The herdsmen-farmer conflicts of the 2010s,

with thousands killed.

The ethnic militia violence — the OPC, MASSOB, Bakassi Boys, each producing its own death toll. The targeted killings of ethnic minorities — the minority community that is attacked because it is minority. The displacement and death in IDP camps — the minority community that is displaced by ethnic violence and that dies in the camp from treatable conditions because the state does not prioritise minority lives.

Slow death in Ethnic Majoritarianism is quiet. Chronic stress of being minority in a majoritarian state — the minority Nigerian who has not slept properly in years because every encounter with the state requires the performance of deference. Mental health collapse from internalised ethnic inferiority — the minority Nigerian who has internalised the majority's framing of their culture as inferior. The slow death of minority languages — the UN estimates that many Nigerian minority languages will be extinct by the end of the century, killed by the education system that uses only majority languages.

The slow death of minority cultures — the ceremonies that can no longer be performed, the knowledge that is no longer transmitted, the identity that is no longer recognised. The slow death of minority land bases — the community whose land is eroded by majority projects, whose territory is reduced by majority expansion. The non-indigene who cannot access state services — the resident who is denied healthcare, education, and employment because they are not indigene. The minority student who pays higher fees. The minority worker who cannot be promoted. The cumulative damage of ethnic discrimination. None of these make the news. They are Ethnic Majoritarianism's quiet tax.

Ruth Wilson Gilmore's definition applies: Ethnic Majoritarianism produces group-differentiated vulnerability to premature death. The groups are the ethnic minorities, the non-indigenes, the settlers, the indigenous peoples of the Middle Belt, the Niger Delta communities, the Plateau communities. The premature death is fast (riots, war, militia violence, targeted killings, displacement death) or slow (stress, internalised inferiority, language death, culture death, land erosion, discrimination damage). Every ascended matrix kills. Ethnic Majoritarianism kills those whose ethnic identity does not fit the majority model.

SECTION 6

6. When Did Ethnic Majoritarianism Rewrite History?

The framework's historical question: when did Ethnic Majoritarianism rewrite history in popular Nigerian living memory?

Pre-colonial Nigerian ethnic boundaries were more fluid. The Yoruba who traded with the Hausa. The Igbo who intermarried with the Ijaw. The Fulani who settled among the Hausa. Ethnic identity existed, but it was not the primary political category. The primary political category was the kingdom, the city-state, the village republic, the caliphate — not the ethnic group. The colonial encounter made ethnic identity the primary political category.

Colonial codification (1900-1960) constructed ethnic identity as political category through the census, the Native Authority system, the indirect rule structure, and the colonial school curriculum. The 1914 amalgamation combined ethnic groups that had not been previously unified under a single state, creating the political unit within which ethnic majoritarianism would operate. The colonial state treated the North as Hausa-Fulani, the West as Yoruba, and the East as Igbo for administrative convenience, erasing the minority groups within each region.

Post-independence replication continued the construction. The 1960 constitution retained the regional structure that mapped onto the three majority groups. The 1963 census was the last to count by ethnic group, because the count was so politically volatile. The Nigeria-Biafra War (1967-70) was the paradigm of ethnic majoritarianism's violence — the secession of the Igbo East, the war that killed 1-3 million people, and the post-war reconciliation that did not dismantle the ethnic classification system.

The tipping point in popular living memory: **circa 1914 for the amalgamation** that combined ethnic groups; **circa 1960 for the consolidation of ethnic arithmetic** in post-independence politics; **circa 1967-70 for the Biafra War** as the paradigm of ethnic majoritarianism's violence. For Nigerians born after 1960, Ethnic Majoritarianism has 'always been' in its current form. They cannot recall a time when ethnic identity was not a political category, when the state-of-origin form did not exist, when the indigene/settler distinction did not govern access.

SECTION 7

7. Fill in the Blank: A Self-Examination

The framework asks two questions of every subject of every ascended matrix. The blanks are for you.

Question 1: When did Ethnic Majoritarianism rewrite your reality?

When did the system teach you that you could not rebel? The moment was: _____. The year was: _____. The person or institution who first made you feel that challenging the ethnic classification was impossible was: _____. The place was: _____. What you wanted to say but did not was: _____. What you did instead was: _____. What you told yourself about why you did not say it was: _____. The ethnic classification you assumed in that moment was: _____. What you lost, in that moment, that you have not got back since, was: _____. The enforcement form at the centre of the moment (state-of-origin, indigene/settler, ethnic quota, ethnic profiling, ethnic voting bloc) was: _____.

Question 2: How is Ethnic Majoritarianism causing your Death?

How is the system shortening your life right now? The form of Death I am most afraid of from Ethnic Majoritarianism is (fast/slow): _____. The specific way it is happening in my body is: _____. (For example: the chronic stress of being a minority in a majoritarian state; the insomnia from years of navigating the indigene/settler distinction; the loss of self from years of being told my ethnic group is inferior; the breakdown I had in 20__ that I have never fully recovered from; the language I no longer speak because the school did not teach it; the culture I no longer practice because the media does not represent it; the land my community lost to the federal project; the non-indigene fee I could not afford; the political office I could not contest; the ethnic profiling I experienced at the checkpoint; the violence I survived in the ethnic riot.) The matrix's name for what is happening to me is: _____. My own name for it is: _____.

If you filled in the blanks honestly, you have just located yourself inside Ethnic Majoritarianism. The next time the triad assembles — the next time the state-of-origin form is filled, the next time the indigene certificate is demanded, the next time the ethnic quota is invoked, the next time the ethnic joke is told — you will be able to see the system moving through you. That sight is the beginning of abolition.

SECTION 8

8. Endnotes & References

References cited inline in this chapter, in APA format. Cumulative references from Chapters 1 through 16 are also included where they recur.

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17. Suberu, R. T. (2001). *Federalism and Ethnic Conflict in Nigeria*. United States Institute of Peace Press. (Source for the analysis of how the federal structure both manages and reproduces ethnic tension.)
18. Young, C. (1976). *The Politics of Cultural Pluralism*. University of Wisconsin Press. (Source for the comparative framework for ethnic politics in postcolonial Africa.)

Coming Next

Chapter 18 will take up Territorialism — the system that ranks the native of a territory above the migrant, enforces territorial identity as political category, and extracts resources and political power from the non-native. The framework's outline names it alongside Ethnic Majoritarianism (Chapter 17) as the two matrices that combine to form the Nationalism intersection. Territorialism overlaps with Ethnic Majoritarianism at the indigene/settler distinction, but is distinct: Territorialism ranks by territorial origin, not by ethnic group. The framework separates them so that the territorial logic specifically can be studied and dismantled.

If you are reading this chapter as part of the framework in progress, the order continues: Chapter 19 is State Sovereignty / Statism, and then the Fundamental Matrices list concludes. After that, the Intersectional Matrices chapter follows. The pattern is now set.